UXDC Designathon 2.0

Nook

Micro-Connections for Campus Life

Serendipity on Campus — a zero-pressure platform bridging disconnected students with peers, spaces, and their own well-being.

Theme: Human Connection

Problem Definition

Students feel painfully disconnected in crowded campus spaces — dining halls, silent library floors, between classes — due to:

Social Friction

Not knowing who is approachable in common areas.

Fear of Rejection

Worry that a cold approach will be awkward or unwelcome.

Academic Burnout

Isolation deepens while studying alone for long hours.

Environmental Alienation

Cozy, underutilized campus spaces go undiscovered.

User Research & Empathy Mapping

Survey Insight: 74% of students want to talk to peers in common areas but don't know who is approachable.

Says

"I wish I could just sit with someone without making it weird."

Thinks

"Everyone else seems to have friends. I'm the only one alone."

Does

Scrolls phone at lunch, avoids eye contact, studies in isolation.

Feels

Lonely, anxious, tired, wanting low-stakes connection.

Persona & Journey Map

Alex — 2nd-year transfer student. Eats lunch alone while scrolling phone. Wants connection but fears rejection and awkwardness.

Journey

1. Feels lonely in the dining hall.
2. Opens Nook → sees open tables nearby.
3. Filters by intent (lunch / study).
4. Pulls up a chair → gentle ping sent.
5. Low-pressure chat or body doubling.
6. Grounding check-in builds a streak.

Solution Concept & Core Features

Open Tables & Study Sparks

Filterable cards by intent with vibe badges and icebreakers. "Pull up a Chair" sends a gentle ping.

Host a Table

Drop a pin, set 1–3 open seats, self-expiring timer, and an icebreaker prompt.

Campus Vibe Map

Rediscover cozy, underutilized spaces by sentiment: Quiet Focus, Lively & Social, Hidden Sunlit Corner.

Daily Grounding

60–second breathing pacer + mood check-in. Awards a streak and suggests rest or reaching out.

UX / UI System & Visual Design

Color Palette

Warm sand #FAF9F5 · Terracotta #E07A5F · Sage #81B29A · Charcoal #2D3142

Typography

Fraunces (display) + Plus Jakarta Sans (body) for warmth and clarity.

Key Decisions

Self-expiring timers, vibe badges, icebreakers, zero-pressure language.

Components

Modern cards, chips, modals, slide-out drawer, responsive grid.

Feasibility, Tech Stack & Impact

Tech Stack

Vanilla JS SPA · Tailwind CSS · Lucide icons · GitHub Pages hosting.

Feasibility

Single-file, no build step, no backend required for MVP demo.

Impact

Reduces social friction, builds streaks of self-care, rediscovers campus.

Privacy

First names only, ephemeral tables, zero-pressure opt-in.

Future Roadmap & Ethics

Roadmap

- Real-time sync via WebSockets
- Anonymous mode & reporting
- Campus admin dashboard
- Accessibility & localization

Ethics

- Consent-first connections
- No persistent tracking
- Inclusive, non-judgmental design
- Mental-health-aware nudges

Thank you — Nook: Serendipity on Campus